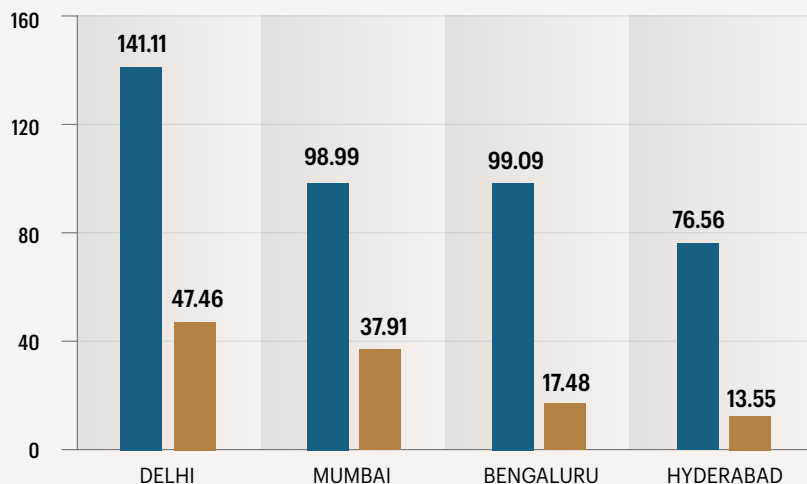


AIRCRAFT MOVEMENT

- Delhi tops with 188,570 flights in just five months;
- Bengaluru is looking to beat Mumbai



● DOMESTIC (IN '000s) ● INTERNATIONAL (IN '000s)
NOTE DATA FOR APRIL TO AUGUST 2025 **SOURCE** AAI



“Getting people to and from an airport efficiently is critical. The best way is through proper road links and metro connectivity from the city centre. Bengaluru remains under-connected”

AJAY AWTANEY
 AVIATION ANALYST

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regulatory regime has matured significantly. “They (Airports Economic Regulatory Authority) give (us) ample opportunity to be heard, which is more than one can ask for,” he says.

Managing costs, however, remains a constant balancing act. Capital expenditure, construction and interest payments form the largest expense components while employee costs and operations drive recurring expenses.

Even so, BIAL operates at enviable margins of 70–72% of Ebitda (earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation, and amortisation), a measure of operating profitability. In doing so, it is helped by its eagle-like focus on reducing cost per passenger as scale increases.

REVENUE STREAMS

Equally crucial to the airport’s long-term vision is the diversifica-

tion of its revenue streams. For instance, non-aeronautical revenue sources such as retail, food and beverages, entertainment, and real estate account for 35% of earnings. The goal is to raise this to 50%.

The list of projects include a 2 million sq. ft office complex, a 775-room hotel, concert arena, convention centre, logistics park, and multiple Maintenance, Repair and Overhaul (MRO) facilities through partnerships with Air India and IndiGo.

Connectivity to the airport, a sore point for Bengaluru residents, is being addressed. Construction of a metro link, Marar claims, is progressing at a “blinding pace” and it should be operational by the third quarter of next year, with tracks inside the airport nearly completed. A suburban rail link is also on the cards.

“Getting people to and from an airport efficiently is critical. The best way is through proper road links and metro connectivity from the city centre... Bengaluru remains under-connected,” says aviation analyst Ajay Awtaney.

To truly become a global transit hub, what the airport needs is a partnership with strong carrier, says Marar. The evolution of BIAL as a hub is only possible through airline-airport partnerships.

To Marar, the future of Indian aviation is brimming with possibilities, although he accepts that periodic turbulence is inevitable.

“Yes, turbulence is in the nature of aviation. But Indian aviation is poised for what I call the golden age,” he says.

The next five years, he says, will be “incredible.” **BT**

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